

Tall Tales/ Fables





About the Course

Along with fairy tales from around the world, this course introduces students to Aesop's famous fables and classic American or Canadian tall tales.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 1



Placement & Combining Tips

Easily combined with hungry Kindergarteners or Grade 2 students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Tall Tales/ Fables 1 time/week 15 min	Aesop's Favorite Fables American Tall Tales The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 1				
		Fairy Tales	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Tall Tales/ Fables



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Literature: Grade 1

☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time together. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Tall Tales/ Fables



Aesop's Favorite Fables



American Tall Tales



The Spirit of Canada: Canada's Story in Legends, Fiction, Poems, and Songs



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Tall Tales/ Fables

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Optional: use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working,

and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 1

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

PREP: Read "Introduction, Notes on the Story" p.x-xii, 3

→ INTRO

These are exaggerated tales of true and imaginary American heroes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-9 "An extraordinary event" - "learn some manners."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

PREP: Read "Tall Tales" p.158

→ INTRO

We'll be reading various tales from Canada this year! Read the short introduction before each tale and then the story itself.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.3-4 "How Two-Feather Was Saved from Loneliness"

★ TEACHER NOTE

The Spirit of Canada includes many different stories, songs, tales, and historical accounts significant to Canadian history. Although students read selected tales in this course, other selections from the book are used in the history courses as well.

WEEK 2 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 2

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

→ INTRO

Locate Davy Crockett on the map at the front of the book. Did he live near your home?

Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States Map"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-13 "So Davy Crockett" - "much better myself."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-6 "Manabozho and the Maple Trees"

★ TEACHER TIP

If you haven't planned for a Community Read Aloud yet, consider adding it to your gathering, meal time, or as a way to lighten the burden of chores! You can find suggestions in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 3

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Davy Crockett

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13 "In spite of" - "in his pocket."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-8 "How the Thunder Made Horses"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

Tall Tales/ Fables

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 4

Dog... & Fox; Town... & Country Mouse

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ INTRO

Fables are short stories that teach a lesson. The characters are most often animals.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.14, 18

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 5 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 5

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Ann Thunder Ann Whirlwind

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.15

→ INTRO

Have you ever been caught out in nature during a rainstorm? Where would be a good place to seek shelter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.17-20 "The backwoods women" - "with the middle!"

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-11 "Scannah and the Beautiful Woman"

★ TEACHER TIP

You can find suggestions for Community Read Alouds in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 6

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Ann Thunder Ann Whirlwind

→ INTRO

What do you think Sally Ann is doing in this picture?

Image Resource: American Tall Tales "Butter Churn" p.16

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-23 "According to her" - "say something else."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-88 "Big Joe Mufferaw"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 7 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 7

The Lion and the Mouse

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using



Term 1

→ PLAY
Act out the fable.

Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 8 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 8

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Stormalong

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.37

→ INTRO

Take a "walk" through the story. Where do you predict this story will take place based on the pictures?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.38-41 "One day in" - "sail with them."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.135-137 "Squid-jiggin' Ground"

WEEK 9 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 9

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Stormalong

→ RECAP

Locate Stormalong on the map in the front of the book. Did he live near your home?

Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States Map"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-47 "But Stormy still" - "his veins again."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.159-161 "Ti-Jean Brings Home the Moon"

WEEK 10 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 10

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Audio Link

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Stormalong

→ INTRO

I wonder what will happen to Stormy when he returns to being a sailor.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.47-49 "Soon Stormy and" - "Alfred Bulltop Stormalong."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ INTRO

Today's story is told by Jan Andrews the author of a collection of Ti-Jean stories called When Apples Grew Noses & White Horses Flew. You can find the book in Extra

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.



Term 1

Helpings if you're interested in reading more!

→ LISTEN, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Audio Link: How Ti-Jean Became a Fiddler

Time Marker: ~ First 11 minutes

WEEK 11 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 11

Materials: None OR Audio Link

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Stormalong

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ LISTEN, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Audio Link: How Ti-Jean Became a Fiddler

Time Marker: Remaining ~11 minutes

WEEK 12 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

American Tall Tales & Aesop's Fables

Spirit of Canada

★ TEACHER TIP

If you haven't tried a Community Read Aloud yet, consider how you might plan for this habit next term!



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 13

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Johnny Appleseed

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.25

→ INTRO

This is one of many Historic Markers placed in different states documenting John Chapman planting apple orchards. He was a real American hero.

∞ Image Link: J. Appleseed Historic Marker

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-30 "There's a ghost" - "fresh from heaven!"

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.164-165 "Johnny Chinook"

WEEK 2 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 14

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Johnny Appleseed

→ INTRO

Locate Johnny Appleseed on the map in the front of the book. Did he live near your home?

Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States Map"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-35 "The traders didn't" - "a new day."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.166-167 "A Fish Story"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

If you haven't planned for a Community Read Aloud yet, consider adding it to your gathering, meal time, or as a way to lighten the burden of chores! You can find suggestions in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 15

The Shepherd Boy and the Wolf

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ INTRO

Why is it important to be truthful? When is it ok to tease?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.24

→ PLAY

Act out the fable.

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.



Term 2

WEEK 4 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 16

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Mose

PREP: "Notes on the Story" p.51

→ INTRO

Do you enjoy seeing fire trucks? Today's story is about a fireman who lived almost 200 years ago.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-56 "Afternoon, Mac!" - "Mose said."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.171 "The Giant Bear"

WEEK 5 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 17

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Mose

→ INTRO

How are today's fire engines different from the one Mose used?

∞ Image Link: Hand-Pumped Fire Engine

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-61 "The volunteers returned" - "twenty feet tall."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.193 "In Flanders Fields"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 6 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 18

Fox and the Stork

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ INTRO

What do you think would happen if a real fox and stork got together?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.44-45

→ PLAY

Act out the fable.

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 7 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 19

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Pecos Bill

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.73

★ TEACHER NOTE
Preview sensitive content on p.74, 78. Also, find suggestions for Community Read Alouds in Quick Links.



Term 2

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard a story about a child living among animals? I wonder what it would be like.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-78 "Ask any coyote" - "Hell's Gate Canyon."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.210-211 "Saskatchewan"

WEEK 8 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 20

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Pecos Bill

→ RECAP

Can you locate Pecos Bill on the map? Who else do you recognize that we have read about? Can you locate where you live?

Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States Map"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-83 "Bill hadn't gone" - "brushing himself off."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.214 "CA-NA-DA"

WEEK 9 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 21

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Pecos Bill

→ RECAP

Do you remember what was happening to Pecos in this picture?

Image Resource: American Tall Tales "Pecos Meets the Gang" p.80-81

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-85 "After his cyclone" - "white-hot shooting stars."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.265 "The Way of Cape Race"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 10 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 22

The Wolf and the House Dog

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.82-83

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

Term 2	
→ PLAY Act out the fable.	
WEEK 11 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 23 Catch-Up Day → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	★ TEACHER TIP If you haven't tried a Community Read Aloud yet, consider how you might plan for this habit next term!
WEEK 12 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: American Tall Tales & Aesop's Fables Spirit of Canada	



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 25

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Febold Feboldson

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.63

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.65-71 "After living on" - "Evening, neighbors."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.266 "And My Heart Soars"

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP
Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 2 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 26

The Dog and His Reflection

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ INTRO
Have you ever seen your reflection in the water?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.96

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 3 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 27

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: John Henry

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.87

→ INTRO
Around 150 years ago, railroad tracks were being built in northeastern states like West Virginia. Many tunnels had to be blasted through mountains.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.88-91 "The night John" - "friends all cheered."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.268-269 "Something to Sing About"

WEEK 4 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 28

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: John Henry

→ INTRO
What is going on in this picture? What is a steam drill used for?
Image Resource: American Tall Tales "Steam Drill, John Henry, and Salesmen" p.92

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.91-95 "That contest will" - "in my hand."

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.



Term 3

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: John Henry Song - Pete Seeger

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.281 "You Have Two Voices"

WEEK 5

15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 29

The North Wind and the Sun

Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ INTRO

Which do you think is stronger, the wind or the sun?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109

→ PLAY

Act out the fable.

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

It's never too late to add a Community Read Aloud! You can find suggestions in Quick Links.

WEEK 6

15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 30

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Paul Bunyan

PREP: Read "Notes on the Story" p.97

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-103 "It seems an" - "found a friend."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.162-163 "Paul Bunyan digs the St. Lawrence River"

WEEK 7

15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 31

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Paul Bunyan

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-105 "Paul Bunyan and" - "of his crew."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.283-284 "How to make a two-room hovel roomier"

WEEK 8

15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 32

Materials: American Tall Tales OR Spirit of Canada

OPTION 1: American Tall Tales: Paul Bunyan

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.



Term 3

→ INTRO

Locate Paul and Babe on the map. Point out the areas and rivers where Paul has traveled.

📄 Map Resource: American Tall Tales "United States"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-109 "Paul wanted the" - "known to happen."

OPTION 2: Spirit of Canada

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.290-291 "I am a Canadian"

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 9

📄 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 33

The Hare and the Tortoise

📄 Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.96

→ PLAY

Act out the fable.

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 10

📄 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 34

The Farmer and His Sons

📄 Materials: Aesop's Fables

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.65

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, pencils, or crayons.

WEEK 11

📄 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 35

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12

📄 15m Tall Tales/ Fables - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

American Tall Tales & Aesop's Fables

Spirit of Canada

Tall Tales/ Fables

Examination

- Term 1**
- American Tall Tales & Aesop's Fables: US Students: Tell about or illustrate Davy Crockett OR Tell about or illustrate Stormalong.
 - OR
 - Spirit of Canada: Canadian Students: Tell a story about Ti-Jean.
- Term 2**
- American Tall Tales: Tell about or illustrate your favorite tall tale character from this term.
- Term 3**
- Aesop's Fables: Tell about one of Aesop's Fables you read this year.
 - OR
 - American Tall Tales: Tell about or illustrate Paul Bunyan.